

Day 51 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Role of Tamil Nadu in the Freedom Struggle, and Early Agitations Against British Rule

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's specific contributions and agitations within the broader Indian freedom struggle — from the earliest 18th-century resistance through the Vellore Mutiny to satyagrahas in the 1920s — with care taken not to repeat the Vaikom/EVR content already covered in the Unit III Satyagraha and Leaders topics.

Q: Real exam: What is the correct chronological order of the South Indian Rebellion, Vellore Mutiny, Sepoy Mutiny, and the Civil Disobedience Movement?

A: South Indian Rebellion (the Poligar Wars era, c. 1799-1801, including Kattabomman/Marudhu Pandiyar's resistance) → Vellore Mutiny (1806) → Sepoy Mutiny (1857) → Civil Disobedience Movement (1930) — confirmed by a real exam question. This places Tamil Nadu's earliest organised resistance to British rule well BEFORE the 1857 Mutiny widely taught as the 'First War of Independence'.

Q: Real exam: What was the Neil Statue Satyagraha, and where did it take place?

A: A protest movement against a statue of British General Neill, located in Chennai (Madras) — confirmed by a real exam question matching it specifically to Chennai (in the same question that correctly matched Simon Commission's arrival to Bombay, the No-Tax movement to Bardoli, and the Temple Entry movement to Vaikom).

Q: Real exam: Who actually started the Vaikom Satyagraha FIRST, before E.V. Ramaswamy (Periyar) joined it?

A: T.K. Madhavan, K.P. Kesava Menon, and George Joseph — confirmed by a real exam question. Periyar's leadership of Vaikom (already covered in the Day 23 Satyagraha topic) came after these three had already initiated it.

Q: Real exam: What is the correct chronological order of E.V. Ramaswamy's (Periyar's) own freedom-struggle-era milestones?

A: He joined the Indian National Congress → organised the Vaikom Satyagraha → became President of the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee → later became President of the Justice Party (marking his eventual split from Congress toward the self-respect/Dravidian movement) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Who is correctly called 'The Father of Modern India' (NOT Periyar, a tempting but wrong distractor)?

A: Raja Ram Mohan Roy — confirmed by a real exam question, which offered Ambedkar, 'Periyar' E.V.R, and Gandhiji as deliberate wrong-but-plausible distractors.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Arrange in chronological order: Civil Disobedience Movement, Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion.

A. South Indian Rebellion, Vellore Mutiny, Sepoy Mutiny, Civil Disobedience Movement ✓

B. Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion, Civil Disobedience Movement, Sepoy Mutiny

C. Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion, Civil Disobedience Movement

D. Civil Disobedience Movement, Sepoy Mutiny, Vellore Mutiny, South Indian Rebellion

Explanation: South Indian Rebellion, Vellore Mutiny, Sepoy Mutiny, Civil Disobedience Movement. [hard, question-bank-2025]

2. The Neil Statue Satyagraha, protesting a statue of a British General, took place in:

A. Bombay

B. Bardoli

C. Vaikom

D. Chennai ✓

Explanation: Chennai. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. The Simon Commission's arrival (1928) sparked major protests, especially in:

A. Chennai

B. Vaikom

C. Bombay ✓

D. Bardoli

Explanation: Bombay. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. Real exam: Who FIRST started the Vaikom Satyagraha, before E.V. Ramaswamy (Periyar) joined it?

A. T. Prakasam, T.K. Madhavan, K.P. Kesava Menon

B. T.K. Madhavan, K.P. Kesava Menon, George Joseph ✓

C. George Joseph, T. Prakasam, T.K. Madhavan

D. K.P. Kesava Menon, T. Prakasam, George Joseph

Explanation: T.K. Madhavan, K.P. Kesava Menon, George Joseph. [hard, question-bank-2017]

5. Arrange in order: E.V. Ramaswamy became President of the Justice Party; he joined Congress; he organised the Vaikom Satyagraha; he became President of the TN Congress Committee.

A. Joined Congress → Vaikom Satyagraha → TN Congress Committee President → Justice Party President ✓

B. Vaikom Satyagraha → Joined Congress → Justice Party President → TN Congress Committee President

C. Justice Party President → TN Congress Committee President → Vaikom Satyagraha → Joined Congress

D. TN Congress Committee President → Joined Congress → Justice Party President → Vaikom Satyagraha

Explanation: Joined Congress, then Vaikom Satyagraha, then TN Congress Committee President, then Justice Party President. [hard, question-bank-2024]

6. Who is correctly known as 'The Father of Modern India'?

A. Ambedkar

B. 'Periyar' E.V.R

C. Gandhiji

D. Raja Ram Mohan Roy ✓

Explanation: Raja Ram Mohan Roy. [medium, question-bank-2017]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Highest Common Factor (HCF)

READING MATERIAL

HCF is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence (4 confirmed hits across 2022/2024/2025) shows TNPSC favors HCF *application* problems — measuring/tiling/container word problems and the HCF-LCM relationship — over plain 'find the HCF of these two numbers' questions, so the reading below leads with those application shapes.

Q: Real exam (2025): Two numbers are in the ratio 15:11. If their HCF is 13, find the numbers.

A: When two numbers are in a given ratio, write them as $15k$ and $11k$. Since $\text{HCF}(15,11)=1$ (the ratio is already in lowest terms), k IS the HCF — so $k=13$. The numbers are $15 \times 13=195$ and $11 \times 13=143$.

Q: Real exam (2025): What is the least number of square tiles needed to pave the ceiling of a room 15m 17cm long and 9m 2cm broad?

A: Convert to one unit: $1517 \text{ cm} \times 902 \text{ cm}$. The LARGEST square tile that exactly fits (no cutting) has a side equal to the HCF of the two dimensions. $\text{HCF}(1517, 902) = 41 \text{ cm}$ (via the Euclidean algorithm: $1517=1 \times 902+615$; $902=1 \times 615+287$; $615=2 \times 287+41$; $287=7 \times 41+0$). Tile area = $41 \times 41 = 1,681 \text{ cm}^2$. Room area = $1517 \times 902 = 1,368,334 \text{ cm}^2$. Number of tiles = $1,368,334 \div 1,681 = 814$.

Q: Real exam (2024): If the HCF of x^3-8y^3 and $x^2-k^2y^2$ is $x+ky$, find k .

A: Factor x^3-8y^3 using $a^3-b^3=(a-b)(a^2+ab+b^2)$ with $a=x$, $b=2y$: $x^3-8y^3 = (x-2y)(x^2+2xy+4y^2)$. Factor $x^2-k^2y^2$ using $a^2-b^2=(a-b)(a+b)$: $x^2-k^2y^2 = (x-ky)(x+ky)$. For ' $x+ky$ ' to be the common factor (HCF) of both, it must match one of the first expression's factors. $(x-2y)$ is the only linear factor available there, so $x+ky$ must equal $x-2y$, giving $k=-2$.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the greatest possible volume of a vessel that can exactly measure the milk in cans of 80, 100, and 120 litres (each can measured to full capacity only)?

A: This is asking for the HCF of 80, 100, and 120. $\text{HCF}(80,100)=20$, then $\text{HCF}(20,120)=20$. So the answer is 20 litres — the largest vessel that can measure each can's full volume an exact whole number of times.

Q: Real exam (2022): The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 16 and 240 respectively. If one number is 48, find the other.

A: Use the relationship: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = \text{product of the two numbers}$. $16 \times 240 = 3,840$. Other number = $3,840 \div 48 = 80$.

Q: Method — finding HCF via the Euclidean algorithm (the fast way for large numbers): What is the HCF of 1517 and 902?

A: Repeatedly divide the larger by the smaller and replace the larger with the remainder, until the remainder is 0 — the last nonzero remainder is the HCF. $1517=1 \times 902+615 \rightarrow 902=1 \times 615+287 \rightarrow 615=2 \times 287+41 \rightarrow 287=7 \times 41+0$. $\text{HCF}=41$. This is the same calculation used in ro2 above — recognize it as the standard fast method rather than listing all factors of both numbers.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Two numbers are in the ratio 21:14. If their HCF is 12, find the larger number.

A. 36 ✓

B. 24

C. 252

D. 168

Explanation: Watch out: 21 and 14 are NOT coprime ($\text{gcd}=7$), so you can't directly multiply them by the HCF. Reduce the ratio first: $21:14 = 3:2$ (coprime). Now apply the HCF: larger = $3 \times 12=36$, smaller = $2 \times 12=24$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the largest square tile that can exactly pave a floor measuring 3m 8cm by 4m 20cm (no cutting).

A. 28 cm ✓

B. 14 cm

C. 56 cm

D. 84 cm

Explanation: Convert to cm: 308 and 420. $\text{HCF}(308,420)$: $420=1 \times 308+112$; $308=2 \times 112+84$; $112=1 \times 84+28$; $84=3 \times 28+0$. $\text{HCF}=28 \text{ cm}$. [hard, authored]

3. If the HCF of a^2-4b^2 and $a^2+ab-6b^2$ is $a-2b$, this is consistent with which factorization of the second expression?

A. $(a+3b)(a-2b)$ ✓

B. $(a-3b)(a+2b)$

C. $(a+3b)(a+2b)$

D. $(a-3b)(a-2b)$

Explanation: $a^2-4b^2=(a-2b)(a+2b)$. The second expression factors as $(a+3b)(a-2b) = a^2+ab-6b^2$ — sharing the common factor $(a-2b)$, so that's the HCF. [hard, authored]

4. What is the greatest volume that can exactly measure the contents of drums holding 72, 96, and 120 litres?

A. 12 litres

B. 24 litres ✓

C. 8 litres

D. 6 litres

Explanation: $\text{HCF}(72, 96) = 24$, then $\text{HCF}(24, 120) = 24$. Answer: 24 litres. [medium, authored]

5. The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 12 and 180 respectively. If one number is 36, find the other.

A. 48

B. 54

C. 60 ✓

D. 72

Explanation: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = 12 \times 180 = 2,160$. Other number = $2,160 \div 36 = 60$. [medium, authored]

6. Using the Euclidean algorithm, find the HCF of 1,073 and 925.

A. 37 ✓

B. 29

C. 31

D. 43

Explanation: $1073 = 1 \times 925 + 148$; $925 = 6 \times 148 + 37$; $148 = 4 \times 37 + 0$. $\text{HCF} = 37$. [medium, authored]

7. Two numbers are in the ratio 8:9 and their HCF is 7. Find their sum.

A. 105

B. 119 ✓

C. 126

D. 112

Explanation: Numbers: $8 \times 7 = 56$ and $9 \times 7 = 63$. Sum = $56 + 63 = 119$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Eidgah" — Munshi Premchand

READING MATERIAL

One of Premchand's most famous stories: a 4-year-old orphan, Hamid, attends the Eid fair with his wealthier friends but, instead of buying toys or sweets for himself, spends his modest Eidi money on a pair of iron tongs for his grandmother — a touching act of selfless love.

Q: How old is Hamid, who does he live with, and what happened to his parents?

A: Hamid is 4 years old. He lives with his grandmother, Ameena. His parents have passed away — his father died of CHOLERA.

Q: What did Ameena tell Hamid about his father, instead of telling him directly that he had died?

A: She told him his father had gone away to earn money — a gentle deception to shield the young child from the painful truth.

Q: Why was Hamid still happy despite his poverty?

A: He trusted that his parents would eventually return — his innocent faith kept him cheerful despite his circumstances.

Q: What festival is being celebrated, and who were most excited about it?

A: Eid. The BOYS (among the village children) were the most excited.

Q: How much Eidi money did Hamid's friends Mahmood and Mohsin have, and what did the boys generally want to buy with their money?

A: Mahmood had 12 coins, and Mohsin had 15 coins (Hamid himself had far less — only a few paisas). The boys generally wanted to buy toys and sweets at the fair.

Q: What did Hamid buy instead of toys or sweets, and for whom?

A: A pair of iron tongs (a 'chimta') — for his grandmother, Ameena.

Q: How did Ameena initially react to receiving the tongs, and what changed her reaction?

A: She initially scolded him for not buying something to eat or enjoy at the fair instead. She burst into tears and blessed him once he reminded her that her fingers get burnt every day while cooking — revealing the depth of thoughtfulness behind his seemingly odd gift.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. How old was Hamid in "Eidgah"?

- A. 5
- B. 4 ✓**
- C. 6
- D. 3

Explanation: 4. [easy, web-research]

2. Who did Hamid live with?

- A. Uncle
- B. Aunt
- C. Father
- D. Granny Ameena ✓**

Explanation: Granny Ameena. [easy, web-research]

3. What disease took Hamid's father's life?

- A. Malaria
- B. Flu
- C. Cholera ✓**
- D. Typhoid

Explanation: Cholera. [medium, web-research]

4. Why was Hamid still happy despite his poverty?

- A. He had many toys
- B. He trusted his parents would return ✓**
- C. He was secretly rich
- D. He had new clothes

Explanation: He trusted his parents would return. [medium, web-research]

5. What did Ameena tell Hamid about his (deceased) father?

- A. He was ill
- B. He left him
- C. He went to earn money ✓**
- D. He went to the city

Explanation: He went to earn money. [medium, web-research]

6. How many coins did Mohsin have at the Eid fair?

- A. 12
- B. 15 ✓**
- C. 9
- D. 14

Explanation: 15. [hard, web-research]

7. What did most of the boys at the fair want to buy?

- A. Clothes and gold
- B. Toys and sweets ✓**
- C. Books and pencils
- D. Watches and mobiles

Explanation: Toys and sweets. [easy, web-research]

8. What did Hamid buy instead, with his Eid money?

- A. A clay toy
- B. Sweets
- C. A pair of iron tongs (chimta) ✓**
- D. A new cap

Explanation: A pair of iron tongs. [medium, web-research]

9. Who did Hamid buy the tongs for, and why?

- A. For himself, to sell later
- B. For his grandmother, because her fingers get burnt while cooking ✓**
- C. For his teacher, as a gift
- D. For a friend who needed one

Explanation: For his grandmother, because her fingers get burnt while cooking. [medium, web-research]

10. How did Ameena react after Hamid explained why he bought the tongs?

- A. She remained angry
- B. She laughed it off
- C. She burst into tears and blessed him ✓**
- D. She returned the tongs

Explanation: She burst into tears and blessed him. [medium, web-research]